

SINGLE-DAY HACKATHON

Detailed Elimination & Judging Criteria

1. Overall Competition Structure

The competition has three stages: idea screening, prototype development, and final demo/judging. Each stage has a defined scoring system and elimination rule.

Stage	Purpose	Duration	Selection
Stage 1	Idea Screening	1–2 hrs	Top 50% advance
Stage 2	Prototype Development	4–5 hrs	Top 30–40% advance
Stage 3	Final Demo & Judging	1–2 hrs	Winners selected

2. Stage 1 — Idea Screening & Elimination

Objective: Select ideas that are relevant, innovative and feasible within a single-day hackathon.

Teams submit: problem statement, proposed solution, target users, technologies, expected impact and basic implementation plan.

Stage 1 — 100 Marks

Criteria	Marks	Judging Focus
Problem relevance & clarity	20	Real, specific and clearly defined problem.
Innovation / originality	20	Novel idea or meaningful improvement.
One-day feasibility	20	Realistic possibility of building a demonstrable MVP.
Technical approach	15	Appropriate and technically sound technologies.
Potential impact	15	Credible social, business, educational or technical value.
Idea presentation	10	Clear and logical communication.
TOTAL	100	

Stage 1 Elimination

- Recommended: top 50% advance.
- Impossible-to-prototype ideas may be rejected.
- Copied/duplicate ideas may be rejected.
- Missing required submission can result in elimination.
- Tie at the cutoff: feasibility, then innovation, then judge discussion.

Example: 40 teams → approximately 20 teams advance.

3. Stage 2 — Prototype Development & Technical Evaluation

Objective: Evaluate whether the team has converted its idea into a meaningful, functional prototype.

Stage 2 — 100 Marks

Criteria	Marks	Judging Focus
Working prototype	25	Core feature works and can be demonstrated.
Technical implementation	20	Effective use of software, AI/ML, APIs, hardware, databases, etc.
Functionality & features	15	Important promised features are implemented.
Innovation	15	Solution remains differentiated.
User experience / UI	10	Usable, understandable interface.
Code quality / architecture	5	Reasonable structure and maintainability.
Progress from original idea	10	Strong progress against the Stage 1 plan.
TOTAL	100	

Stage 2 Elimination

- Recommended: strongest 30–40% proceed to final.
- Teams should demonstrate at least a functional MVP/proof-of-concept.
- Strong idea + no implementation should not automatically beat a working solution.
- Failure to submit the prototype on time may result in elimination.

Example: 20 teams → 6–8 finalists.

4. Stage 3 — Final Demo, Pitch & Judging

Recommended format: 3–5 minutes presentation/live demo + 2–3 minutes Q&A; per finalist.

Final — 100 Marks

Criteria	Marks	Judging Focus
Problem & solution clarity	15	Problem, users, solution and value are clear.
Working demonstration	25	Prototype works and demonstrates the main use case.
Technical depth	15	Team understands architecture and implementation decisions.
Innovation & uniqueness	15	Solution stands out from alternatives.
Real-world impact	10	Credible practical/social/commercial impact.
Scalability / future potential	10	Clear path beyond the hackathon.
Presentation & Q&A	10	Communication, confidence and technical defense.
TOTAL	100	

5. Overall Winner Calculation

Recommended weighting gives the final working solution the greatest importance:

Stage	Weight	Calculation
Stage 1 — Idea	20%	Score × 0.20
Stage 2 — Prototype	30%	Score × 0.30

Stage	Weight	Calculation
Stage 3 — Final	50%	Score × 0.50
FINAL	100%	Sum of weighted scores

Example: 80, 85 and 90 → $(80 \times 0.20) + (85 \times 0.30) + (90 \times 0.50) = 86.5/100$.

6. Tie-Breaker Rules

1. Higher final-stage working-demonstration score.
2. Higher technical-depth score.
3. Higher innovation score.
4. Higher impact score.
5. Final judge-panel vote.

7. Immediate Disqualification

- Plagiarism or substantial copying.
- Presenting a previously completed project as new.
- Misrepresentation of work or contribution.
- Deliberately interfering with another team.
- Serious misconduct or rule violation.
- Failure to submit required deliverables.
- Use of prohibited resources where event rules restrict them.

8. Recommended Selection Flow

All Teams → Stage 1 → Top 50% → Stage 2 → Top 30–40% → Final Demo → Weighted Scoring → Top 3 Winners

9. Recommended Special Awards

- Best Overall Solution
- Runner-up
- Second Runner-up
- Best Innovation
- Best AI/ML Solution
- Best Social Impact
- Best Technical Implementation

10. Judge Guidelines

Judges should score independently where possible, apply the same core questions to every finalist, focus on actual work rather than reputation, and complete score sheets immediately after each evaluation. With multiple judges, average the scores for each criterion.